

in 1707. He may also have composed the Toccata and Fugue in D minor—one of his most celebrated organ works—around this time.

Bach followed a strict Lutheran code of sexual morality. The only early evidence of interest in women was a complaint from church authorities that he had allowed a “strange maiden” into the Arnstadt organ loft. In 1707, buoyed by a small inheritance from his maternal uncle, he married his second cousin, Maria Barbara. They had seven children, only four of whom survived infancy. Most of these births took place at the ducal court at Weimar, where, from 1708, Bach was an organist and later a concertmaster.

